

Leave Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Leave Policy is to provide employees with time off from work for rest, personal matters, illness, and other important life events while ensuring that business operations continue effectively.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time employees of the company. Leave eligibility for contract employees, consultants, and interns will be governed by the terms specified in their respective contracts.

3. Leave Entitlements

3.1 Earned Leave (EL) / Annual Leave

- Employees are entitled to **18 days of Earned Leave per calendar year**.
- Earned Leave is accrued **monthly on a pro-rata basis**.
- Employees can carry forward unused Earned Leave to the next year up to a **maximum limit of 30 days**.
- Any leave balance exceeding the carry-forward limit may lapse or be encashed as per company policy.
- Earned Leave should normally be planned in advance.

3.2 Casual Leave (CL)

- Employees are entitled to **6 days of Casual Leave per year**.
- Casual Leave is intended for **short personal requirements or emergencies**.
- Casual Leave **cannot be carried forward** to the next calendar year.
- A maximum of **3 consecutive days** of Casual Leave may be taken at a time unless approved by the reporting manager.

3.3 Sick Leave (SL)

- Employees are entitled to **12 days of Sick Leave per year**.
- Sick Leave may be used when an employee is unable to work due to illness or medical conditions.
- For Sick Leave exceeding **2 consecutive days**, the company may request a **medical certificate**.
- Sick Leave **cannot be carried forward**.

3.4 Maternity Leave

- Female employees are eligible for **26 weeks of paid maternity leave**, in accordance with the **Maternity Benefit Act applicable in India**.

- Employees must inform HR and their reporting manager at least **8 weeks in advance** where possible.
- Additional unpaid leave may be granted subject to medical recommendation and management approval.

3.5 Paternity Leave

- Male employees are entitled to **5 working days of paid paternity leave** following the birth or adoption of a child.
- This leave should typically be taken within **30 days of childbirth or adoption**.

3.6 Bereavement Leave

- Employees may take **up to 3 days of paid leave** in the event of the death of an immediate family member such as spouse, parent, child, or sibling.

3.7 Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to **public holidays declared by the company** as per the annual holiday calendar. The holiday list is published at the beginning of each calendar year.

3.8 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

- If an employee has exhausted all available leave balances, they may request **Leave Without Pay (LWP)**.
- LWP must be approved by the **Reporting Manager and HR**.
- Salary deductions will apply for the duration of LWP.

4. Leave Application Procedure

- All leave requests must be submitted through the **company's leave management system or HR portal**.
- Employees should apply for planned leave **at least 3 working days in advance**.
- In case of emergency leave, employees must inform their **Reporting Manager as soon as possible**.
- Leave is considered approved only after **manager approval in the system**.

5. Leave Approval

- Leave approval is subject to **business requirements and team workload**.
- Managers reserve the right to **reschedule leave requests if necessary** to ensure operational continuity.

6. Leave During Notice Period

- Leave during the notice period is generally **discouraged**.
- Any leave during the notice period must be **approved by both the Reporting Manager and HR**.

- In some cases, the notice period may be **extended to compensate for leave taken**.

7. Misuse of Leave

Providing false information or misuse of leave policies may result in **disciplinary action**, which may include warnings or other actions as per company disciplinary procedures.

8. Policy Amendments

The company reserves the right to **modify or update this policy** at any time in accordance with business needs and applicable laws.